

PYROGRE'S BACHELOR PAD



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I induced lucidity through sleep paralysis and arrived alone on a rooftop above a wide city.



Because I knew I was dreaming, I began trying custom superhero power suits as easily as changing clothes.



The first suit gave me a jet pack, and it lifted me into the air exactly as intended.



It worked, but it felt plain. Flying was not enough if the suit itself did not feel like mine.



I tried an armored version of the jet-pack suit, hoping protection would give it the missing identity.



The armor made me safer, but it still felt like a generic machine wrapped around me.



Built-in laser weapons brought the design closer to the kind of superhero technology I imagined.



Unfortunately, every new weapon added more metal, more weight, and less freedom.



The most advanced suit was also the one I wanted to escape, so I abandoned powered armor entirely.



I replaced every suit with one light yellow belt that created an anti-gravity force field around me.



The belt let me fly without a jet pack and protected my entire body without heavy armor.



When I flexed a limb in one direction, the field projected a powerful shockwave in that same direction.



A precise motion focused that force into a beam, while a wide stance fortified the field into all-around protection.



Flight, offense, and defense now came from my own movement. The power finally felt free.



I loved the belt, but I still wanted an actual superhero suit that expressed who I had become.



I chose a full black mask with white eye lenses, green armored chest padding, black gloves and boots, and a black cape lined in orange.



The yellow belt remained the center of the design because its lightness was the reason the whole costume worked.



Fully dressed at last, I launched into the sky to enjoy the city and the simple pleasure of my new powers.



Then a giant flaming ogre appeared, and the peaceful flight suddenly looked like the beginning of another monster battle.



I told him, "Sometimes I just want to enjoy my powers instead of having to fight a big monster."



The ogre lowered his hands and answered, "That is fine. I am a hero too, and I did not come to fight you."



His name was Pyrogre. The moment we spoke honestly, the expected battle disappeared and a much stranger invitation replaced it.



Pyrogre swallowed me safely, and I discovered that the inside of his body contained a comfortable bachelor pad.



Beneath enormous rib arches, he had a sofa, snacks, a game screen, and an entire neon arcade.



Pyrogre explained that damage from inside his body makes him stronger instead of weaker.



I used the belt to punch one of his enormous bones in the training area, carefully keeping the force away from his furniture.



The impact strengthened him immediately. His flames burned brighter, and both of us enjoyed a power-up that required no enemy at all.



Pyrogre was powerful, very nice, and just as interested in enjoying heroism as I was.



Together we became an incredible superhero team focused more on relaxing than searching for a world to save.



That did not mean we would ignore anyone in need. It meant we would help when a real situation demanded it instead of inventing a fight.



With freedom, friendship, and an arcade between adventures, Pyrogre and I had found our own way to be heroes.

